

Emergency Response Procedures - Elevating Devices

Rocket Elevators - Ontario Fleet Technical Reference

Overview

This document sets out the immediate response procedures for the five most common emergency conditions on Ontario elevating devices. All field technicians must be familiar with these procedures. For life-safety emergencies, call 911 before any other action.

Passenger Entrapment

1. Establish voice contact with entrapped passengers immediately via the emergency telephone or intercom.
2. Advise passengers to stay calm, stay in the car, and do not attempt to force doors open or climb out.
3. Dispatch a licensed mechanic - target arrival within 30 minutes for occupied buildings; 60 minutes for after-hours.
4. If medical emergency is reported, call 911; advise fire department of floor location and number of passengers.
5. Mechanic must use inspection drive to bring car to nearest landing before manually opening doors - never force landing doors with car between landings.

Power Failure

1. If the building has an emergency generator, verify it has started and check whether the elevator is on emergency power circuit.
2. If ARD (Automatic Rescue Device) is installed, it will automatically move the car to the nearest landing and open doors - verify within 5 minutes.
3. If no ARD: dispatch mechanic; use battery-powered inspection unit if available.
4. Do not restore building power while mechanic is in the hoistway.

Fire Service Mode Failure

If a fire alarm activates and the elevator does not recall to the primary landing:

1. Manually activate Phase I by turning the key switch at the lobby to ON.
2. If the elevator still does not return, shut the elevator down and call TSSA.
3. Do not attempt to use the elevator for evacuation - fire service operation is for trained fire department personnel only.
4. Notify building fire safety plan coordinator immediately.

Uncontrolled Movement / Overspeed

If a car is reported to have moved unexpectedly or at abnormal speed:

1. Take the elevator out of service immediately - do not run in Normal mode.
2. Inspect governor trip mechanism, safety wedges, and brake for signs of operation (wear marks, displaced parts).
3. Do not return the elevator to service until a licensed mechanic has confirmed the cause and corrected it.
4. File an incident report with TSSA within 24 hours per Ontario Regulation 209/01.

Earthquake / Seismic Event

1. Elevators with seismic shutdown switches will automatically stop at the nearest landing and open doors after an event - do not override until a mechanic has inspected the hoistway.
2. Inspect guide rails for displacement, counterweight for shifting, and pit for structural damage before returning to service.
3. TSSA must be notified if any structural damage is found.

TSSA Reporting Requirements

Ontario Regulation 209/01, Section 14 requires that the owner report to TSSA within 24 hours any incident involving:

- Injury to a person
- Unintended car movement of more than 300 mm
- Activation of the governor and safety
- Structural failure of any component

Use TSSA online portal or call 1-877-682-8772 (after hours: emergency line).